

THE GOLD RUSH: A MULTICULTURAL AND AN INTERNATIONAL EVENT

When we think of the typical forty-niner, we usually think of an American, a young white man with European ancestry. And while thousands of these young men left their shops in Boston and Philadelphia, and their farms in Ohio and Indiana to head for California, they were by no means the only group to come to California during the Gold Rush.

Within what was then the United States other groups of people also saw the Gold Rush as an opportunity. One of these was black Americans, both free blacks from the North and slaves from the South. Though this was before the Civil War and the Emancipation Proclamation, there were large communities of free blacks in some cities of the North. However, even though free, their economic and educational opportunities were often very limited. The Gold Rush presented them with the possibility of a greater chance to succeed on the same level as whites. And for the slaves, the Gold Rush presented the possibility of freedom.

Another group seldom mentioned is that of women. Most accounts of the Gold Rush dismiss the presence of women by saying that, except for a few saloon girls, women did not participate. Yet, though far fewer in number than men, women were in the Gold Rush from the beginning, with men and alone, and participated in all aspects of it, including mining.

In addition to the Gold Rush being a westward movement of Americans, it also became a northward and eastward movement of people from many nations and cultural groups. Those most like the Americans were whites who came from Europe and Australia. By 1855, some 30,000 Europeans had come to California, mostly from the British Isles, Germany and France.

Coming northward first were Mexicans, mostly from Sonora, Sinaloa, Chihuahua and Durango. The news of gold spread quickly to Mexico, and prospectors from Sonora were among the first to arrive in the summer of 1848. They headed for the southern mining area, and soon established their own camp, which they named Sonora. By 1849 others were coming north from Peru, Argentina and Chile.

Coming eastward from Asia were the Chinese. Their numbers were small at first, but increased as the word spread in the Chinese cities and countryside of opportunity in the gold fields and of high-paying jobs in California. The Chinese settled in the larger camps throughout the gold country. They kept to themselves and formed their own Chinatowns. They also formed Chinatowns in the cities, where some successfully started businesses.

This was not a period of great understanding or tolerance for cultural differences for Americans. It was a period of American expansionism, and the American government was determined to expand American's borders westward and southward. Americans believed that they had the best government in the world and therefore, American expansion was for the good of everyone. This attitude could be seen in the white Americans who came west beginning in 1849.

At first foreigners and those of other cultures were tolerated, but as more and more people flocked to the gold fields, hostility toward foreigners grew. Many miners and other Americans

PLACER MINING/separating the gold

Although gold had been discovered in California by the early Native American and Mexican populations, the "Gold Rush" finds its beginning in 1848, when gold was discovered by Marshall at Sutter's Mill in Coloma. The rush to the California gold fields was on. For the first year or two gold was easily attained, yield was near 12 cents per pan. A dedicated miner could make wages of \$20.00 daily.

Within two years, easily attained gold was depleted, and it was considered a good claim if color was found in five or six pans. Wages were down to \$3.00 a day. At this time, Gold panning was still the most efficient way of recovering gold from any type of gold bearing material, however it was very tedious and back breaking labor. With a gold pan, a miner can process about 1/2 cubic yard of material a day. The rocker box is not quite as efficient, however one could process two to four cubic yards per day. Even if you would lose a little gold, you could process about eight times as much material on any given day. A sluice or Long-tom (a long sluice) is only 1/2 as efficient as a gold pan, but with this device you can process four to eight yards of material. Now even though you are only recovering 1/2 of the gold in any given amount of gravel, you could realize more profit with less back breaking effort. You would be capable of processing up to 16 times the amount of material than with the traditional gold pan.

After gold was collected in sluices, it had to be removed and then separated from the accompanying debris. Quicksilver (mercury) was used for this purpose. Deposited in the sluices and mixed to form an amalgam (quicksilver, gold, and other materials), it was taken up from the sluice floor and taken to the "Pan House", where the dirt was removed. The amalgam was converted to its component parts with a retort. In the retort the quicksilver vaporizes and the gold is left behind. This gold is commonly called "sponge". This sponge is poured into graphite crucibles and heated once more and then poured into molds. To stop the gold from sticking to the mold, a carbon deposit was formed on the mold by burning a pitchy stick. The gold was then shined up with nitric acid and sent off to Nevada City.

INVENTION OF HYDRAULIC MINING

Miller, Chabot, Matteson

In the early Spring of 1852, Eli Miller (a tinsmith), Anthony Chabot (an engineer), and Edward Matteson (a jack-of-all-trades), met in Sacramento and decided to come up to the gold fields to try their luck. They pooled their resources and set off to find work as gold miners and wound up in an area known as "DEER CREEK DRY DIGGINS" (Nevada City). It did not take long to learn the use of ground sluices, rocker boxes and long toms. Once they became accomplished in these techniques, they decided to do some prospecting of their own. Matteson stayed on at the diggings they had found employment at while Miller and Chabot founded a new claim at Buck Eye Hill near Red Dog. Since ground sluicing was completely controlled by spring run off and snow pack, (no water, no sluicing) the three partners looked for summer work in what is now known as Nevada City. Matteson went to work for A.B. Caldwell, owner of Caldwell's Upper Store as a freight wagon driver. When the Autumn weather started its cooling trend, Chabot and Miller returned to their claim and awaited the wet weather. Matteson stayed on with Caldwell to deliver supplies to all the mining claims. While waiting for the rains, Chabot made a 100 foot six inch diameter hose from strips of saddlebag canvas and Miller constructed a three foot funnel. With this invention it was now possible to bring water to the diggings which was far better than taking your excavated gravel to the water for processing.

Late in 1852 or beginning in 1853, when Matteson finished his work at Caldwell's and joined his companions at their claim, he suggested that another funnel be turned around and attached to the discharge side of the hose. A three foot nozzle with an inch and a half outlet was fabricated by Miller and when attached, began a new era in gold mining techniques.

With this new contraption, they had created a monster. More earth was loosened than the sluice could handle. Miller built a 200 foot long 12 inch pipe in 12 foot slip jointed sections to bring water down to a distribution box (designed by Matteson) which had two six inch hoses attached. With this system, enough water came to the sluices to handle all the earth loosened by the nozzle. Caldwell backed the manufacture of these devices as he wanted the same type of set up at his own claim at American Hill, just to the north of Nevada City. Because Matteson was seen bringing equipment to American Hill he was given the credit for the invention of Hydraulic Mining.

Obviously the need for water with this type of system was much greater than simple ground sluicing operations, and at this time they were paying 75 cents per miner's inch of water. (A much disputed measurement for water consumption used in most mines. In 1901, Legislature determined that a Miner's inch was 1 1/2 cubic feet of water through any given source of water transportation in one minute or 90 cubic feet of water an hour). The water bill at this claim of the three partners ran \$153.00 a week, however they were capable of making \$50.00 per day per partner.

Matteson also was responsible for a hydraulic derrick used to move large boulders out of the workings and a hydraulic powered set of steel bars on a portable platform for prying large cemented types of materials loose. He also invented a device for keeping debris from entering the intakes of hydraulic systems. Though he invented these and other power tools, he failed to seek patent rights and died a poor man in Nevada City in 1903. His gravesite is still unknown.

In 1853, sheet iron pipe was introduced and used by R.R. Craig on American Hill in Nevada City. By 1856, a firm in San Francisco began to manufacture wrought iron pipe for hydraulic mining.

In 1856, Chabot left the gold fields of California and pursued his interests in engineering. He is credited for San Francisco's first regular water system in 1858. He also developed a water system for Portland, Maine and Milwaukee, Wisconsin. He became one of the incorporators of Oakland's Gas Light Company in 1866. He built the dam on San Leandro Creek (now Lake Chabot) and was partly if not solely responsible for water systems in Oakland and San Jose. He died in the bay area a multi-millionaire in 1888, leaving over \$85,000 to charities in the greater bay area. Chabot Observatory is named after A. Chabot.

General Information

WATER SUPPLY

The objective was to collect and store large quantities of water at an elevation considerably higher than that of the ground to be worked, to transport this water to the mine and feed it to the monitors via a closed pipeline. Main ditches generally followed the sinuous topographic contours with flumes and pipelines constructed to convey water along steep slopes and across steep ravines. At the delivery end, water was impounded in smaller reservoirs for immediate use. From these intermediate reservoirs, ditches carried the water to the head of the supply line, notably pressure boxes. These boxes eliminated air bubbles, removed sediment and calmed the turbulent waters. A large iron funnel was attached to the bottom of the pressure box which conveyed the water from the trough to the pipeline. The main pipe itself was constructed of iron sheets, rolled and riveted to form a cylinder up to 2' in diameter. Ideally, this pipe descended to the Diggins in a direct line as possible. These feeder lines were equipped with air valves at strategic points, to allow escape of entrapped air while filling, and to prevent the collapse of pipe due to the vacuum that would be created if a break in the line occurred. Water was diverted to one or more lateral lines, usually of smaller dimension, which fed the hydraulic nozzle. The monitors and lateral lines were moved across the main floor as the surrounding banks receded.

The major water supply for the working of the Malakoff Mine was delivered via the Bowman ditch. The origin of this ditch was the Bowman Reservoir; located at the headwaters of the Yuba River at Big Canyon Creek. The ditch was 40 miles long, 5' wide at the bottom, 8.65' wide at the top, and 3 1/2' deep. It had a grade of 16' per mile. Water from the ditch was delivered to Waldron Reservoir for Malakoff's needs. The ditch was completed in 1869 by 800 Chinese and 300 whites.

General Information

DRAIN TUNNELS

The Hiller Tunnel was built between 1851 and 1856 and financed by Dr. Hillerscheidt and D. Albert. Dr. Hillerscheidt claimed water rights in 1857. The history and records were burned at the County Recorder's office in 1856, so no prior claims are known. The tunnel was used for drainage at a small mining concern at the present site of Malakoff Diggins. This mine was later bought by North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company. The tunnel is now used as a model of the larger tunnel below.

In 1860, Julius Poquillion, bought up small mining claims at very low prices: Many of the miners were moving to better pickings in Nevada. He soon owned 1535 acres and had plans to develop a large scale mining operation. In 1866, he succeeded in attracting investors from San Francisco and developed the North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company. As the company expanded they bought the Bowman Ranch and developed a reservoir and ditch system to bring more water to the diggins. These were designed by Hamilton Smith Jr. and work was completed on September 15, 1870. The company soon discovered that they were using more water than the Hiller Tunnel could drain and they would soon be working below the level of the tunnel. They decided to build a bigger tunnel down closer to bedrock and below the blue gravel layer which contained the most gold. Again the services of Hamilton Smith Jr. were called upon.

The tunnel was begun in April or May of 1872. Eight shafts were sunk at 1,000 foot intervals in line with the proposed tunnel. Two crews would go to the bottom of the shaft and begin digging in opposite directions on the tunnel line. Ultimately there were some fifteen crews digging simultaneously to complete the hard rock tunnel. On November 15, 1874, the tunnel was completed. It has been estimated that this is one year sooner than the feat could have been accomplished had it simply been dug from the head of Humbug Canyon straight through to the Malakoff Diggins.

The mouth of the tunnel was 6 1/2 feet high and six feet wide. From Shaft six to Shaft eight, the tunnel was eight feet square. At it's starting point in the Diggins, the tunnel was 75 feet below the gold bearing gravel of the ancient tertiary river channel; but by the time it opened on to the Humbug Canyon, the tunnel was nearly 400 feet beneath the channel. It was important for the tunnel to be in bedrock so that when the debris washed down Shaft eight and into the tunnel, the force would not completely distort the shape of the tunnel. The debris flowed down the tunnel at a 4% grade and out into the Humbug Canyon where it moved one mile further, along "under currents", before dumping into the South Fork of the Yuba River. The men employed to dig this tunnel were paid between \$3.50 and \$6.00 per eight hour day.

Although the tunnel and its eight shafts are now filled with debris and water, it is still considered one of the engineering feats of all time. Hamilton Smith Jr., without the aid of sophisticated engineering tools and instruments, accomplished what many modern engineers could not.

General Information

NORTH BLOOMFIELD BEGINNINGS

As legend has it, in 1851 or 1852, a prospecting party consisting of two Irishmen and a German, discovered a rich deposit of gravel on the north bank of a creek, about 15 miles from Nevada City and three miles up from the South Yuba. After a short time their supplies began to diminish and it was decided that one of the Irishmen would go to Nevada City for food and equipment. Before departing, the Irishman pledged total silence to his friends as to the whereabouts of their claim. When he arrived in Nevada City, with several hundred dollars worth of gold dust, many of the townsfolk took notice at the size of the Irishman's poke. After procuring the necessary goods, the miner stopped at a local tavern and discussed his good fortunes with local miners, but even free liquor could not pry the information from the miner as to the whereabouts of his claim. The prospector left town before sunrise, however his leaving did not go unnoticed. He was tracked and followed by more than a hundred eager miners, waiting for him to show the way to these well hidden riches. When the miners arrived, a tent city arose on the banks of the creek and expectations of untold wealth were envisioned. The pickings were disappointing and the disgruntled miners labeled the area as a "Humbug", meaning a lousy claim. Many of the prospectors returned to Nevada City. However, a few remained and referred to their settlement as Humbug or Humbug City and the creek as Humbug Creek.

After several years, the residents had submitted "Humbug" as the name of their town in order to get a post office. The Postal Service having received too many requests for that same name during that time period refused all requests. The name "Bloomfield" was submitted but there already existed another town by that name in Sonoma County. They finally settled on the name of "North Bloomfield" in 1857.

The origin to the name of the mine as "Malakoff" is not certain. It is possible that the name was brought to this country by the French miners. The French were involved in the Crimean War where a battle was fought at Fort Malakov (Malakoff) in Russia. It seems that the cliffs of the mine may have reminded them of the area surrounding the Russian fort. A story has also been told about a rock abutment above the harbor at Cornwall, England also named Malakoff. Many Cornish miners came to the area during the gold rush and may have given the mine its name. Finally, park historian Loni Patterson, has found one reference to "A. Malakoff and Company", in a historic newspaper article.

General Information

McKILLICAN-MOBLEY GENERAL STORE

The main room of the store dates back to 1856 when it was run by Mayhew and Pettijean. In 1857 it was the "well provisioned general store of H.K. Brownell". It again changed hands and was given the side addition when T.P. Crandall took over in the 1870s. Crandall later took on a partner, R.D. McKillican and the store operated under both names until Mr. Crandall moved to Berkeley. R.D. McKillican retained two-thirds interest in the store with Walter Mobley acquiring one-third ownership and eventually the named changed to its current title.

As you approach the building you'll notice six vertical columns partially painted with a dark gray paint. The pillars were painted this color simply because it permitted horseback riders to tie directly to the columns. White would have attained a soiled look much sooner. The two gray boards with pointed tops on the front of the building are bulletin boards where election notices and returns, hunting regulations, theatrical presentations and other miscellaneous information was posted. A letter slot at the post office window served as a mail drop.

The steel bars over the windows are an original feature of the security system. To further enhance the security of the store, an employee, generally the freight driver served as a night watchman and was required to sleep overnight in the 8 foot x 8 foot room in the north part of the building. There was also a large white pit bull watchdog to further discourage thieves. The store not only had valuable and much needed supplies, but also served as a gold exchange and a drop off point for gold shipments.

The proprietor of the store made two annual trips into one of the major supply centers. This was generally accomplished in the Fall and Spring. To enhance his inventory between purchasing dates, the owner would do some ordering by mail. When doing so, the freight would be shipped from either Sacramento or San Francisco to Colfax by Southern Pacific Railroad. From Colfax the merchandise was transferred to Nevada City by the Narrow Gauge Railroad, then hauled by store freight teams to North Bloomfield.

The store had a wide variety of goods to select from. The Levis on the shelves are of historic influence as Levi Strauss manufactured the first Levis for the miners of the California gold fields. The store also sold kerosene for lamps, ammunition, hardware, mining supplies, stationery, soap, kitchen utensils, paint, some medications, eggs, oranges and bakery goods such as cookies, chocolate eclairs, figbars, gingersnaps etc. Canned meat, cured meats, deviled ham and dried foods were also available and were considered to be a staple part of the diet of this region. Mr. McGagin had milk cows which supplies fresh milk to the community. Vegetables were not sold at the store since they were available at the China gardens for a minimal price. Fresh meats were available at the butchershop across the street.

Gold was the normal means of exchange. It was either sold at the store or traded for supplies. Many of the merchants had scales for transaction purposes.

General Information

The general store was an effective social center for the community and at the close of a days labor in the mines, the workers would congregate around the stove and exchange tidbits of gossip and chaws of tobacco. If they were not subscribers to the temperance movement, they would adjourn to the basement. In the basement were two large barrels with whiskey glasses. The miners would serve themselves to the free beverage that the storekeeper generously provided. The ladies would meet at the post office inside the front door and exchange further tidbits of gossip.

The high doors and ceilings were so designed to aid in ventilating the building during the warmer summer months. The door handles are low according to today's standards, but perhaps this was the standard height in the mining days.

Aside from the owners, there were normally five additional employees; a teamster who drove four-, six- and eight-horse teams in delivering freight from Nevada City; a driver for local delivery who drove a two- or four-horse wagon; a full time mail clerk; a stock boy who swept, cleaned and stacked the shelves; and a young woman who distributed the mail and performed the clerical work in the post office. Historians claim the arrival of the daily stage was one of the more exciting moments of the day for residents of North Bloomfield. Men and women would gather at stage time and wait until the mail was distributed and talk about news of the day. The post office was also responsible for selling fishing and hunting licenses to the sportsmen in the area.

There was a marked decline in business following the Sawyer decision of 1884, but the store continued serving the region throughout the 19th and the first few decades of the 20th century. The store officially closed in 1941 with Noni Landsburg serving as the last postmaster.

General Information

SMITH-KNOTWELL DRUGSTORE

Adrian A. Smith was a native of Pittsburg, Pennsylvania. He became a college graduate in the study of medicine and the teaching profession. He married Maria Hughes and moved to Ohio, where he continued in the study of medicine. In 1856, he moved to California by way of the Panama Canal and settled in Rough and Ready with an uncle, Nathaniel Smith, who operated a sawmill. A.A. Smith was a member of the State Assembly during the sessions of 1863-64. In 1869 he was listed as a school teacher in North Bloomfield. From 1873 to 1889, A.A. Smith was Justice of the Peace in North Bloomfield. In 1875, A.A. Smith was noted in the North San Juan paper, as being a druggist and selling medicine to a man that later died.

A.A. Smith purchased the corner lot on Relief Hill and North Bloomfield Road in 1872. At that time there was a small house on the property. It is possible that Smith was operating a small drugstore business from a closed in front porch. In 1876 he remodeled and built the drugstore building and operated as the "Smith Drugstore". The top meeting hall was originally used by the Independent Order of Good Templars and the Knights of Pithias. Sometime between 1880 and 1882 the Masons moved into the upstairs.

John Knotwell, the co-owner of Knotwell-Atwater Drug Store in Moore's Flat, was in this area in 1864 and prior to his arrival resided in Valley Forge, Chester County, Pennsylvania. As early as 1876, the North San Juan paper mentions that Knotwell was working with A.A. Smith as a druggist. In the census of 1880, John was shown to be living with A.A. Smith as a boarder. John Knotwell married Nettie Smith, a daughter of A.A. Smith, in Nevada City on July 20, 1881. Shortly thereafter, the drugstore became known as the Smith-Knotwell Drugstore when A.A. Smith moved from town and left Nettie and John in charge.

From 1900 to 1908 it was known as the North Bloomfield Drug Company. The store manager, J.G. McKinney, also related to Smith and Knotwell, probably occupied the living quarters, as was customary during this period, for security reasons.

The current building is a reconstruction project completed by the Masonic Lodge, E Clampus Vitus and the State of California between 1976-1984.

General Information

NORTH BLOOMFIELD SCHOOL

The first school in North Bloomfield was built in 1857 and was found closer to the picnic area in town. The school standing today was most likely constructed in 1873 at a cost to the townspeople of \$3,700, complete with furnishings and its own library. Classes were held for kindergarten through eighth grades, all in the same room with two or three students per desk. The left wing of the school was added during the 1880s to accommodate expanded enrollment. As many as 144 students took lessons from two teachers in the L-shaped two roomed schoolhouse the first year the school was opened. F.D. McAlister served as the principal and teacher and received a salary of \$90.00 per month. His assistant, Mrs. McDonald received \$50.00 per month.

The school served as a church and Sunday school on weekends. Catholic, Episcopalian and Methodist religious services were conducted here. The school also served the community as a town meeting hall before Cummins Hall was constructed.

Directly behind the building one will find a depression in the earth which was a pond that the school kids swam in, much to the dislike of the principal. The pond was part of the LeDu hydraulic mine.

The park visitor will notice the numerous blackboards in the main part of the building. Blackboards were used as the primary teaching aid since paper products were so scarce during the gold rush era. The children used slate boards and chalk to do homework. The bench at the front of the classroom was used to seat children who were being disciplined, and the two small rooms at the entrance are cloak rooms. The large hooks on the ceiling in the main room were used to support the stovepipe so that the building could be heated during the colder months. An unusual feature of the school is a ventilator in the center of the ceiling that can be manipulated from the teacher's desk. The schoolroom was lighted by kerosene lamps. The schoolmarm and master both lived near the school, in separate cottages, perhaps near or on the sites of the Gin Yet Wah and Skidmore cabins. Separate "four holer" pit toilets, for boys and girls, may be found behind the school. A short bell tower and a cupola are located on the ridge of the roof near the front of the structure. The school was last used in 1941 and has been owned and maintained by the Department of Parks and Recreation since 1973. The Washington School District still retains provisional use of the building if emergency circumstances warrant doing so.

General Information

SAINT COLUMCILES CATHOLIC CHURCH

St. Columciles Catholic Church is not native to the town of North Bloomfield. But it was constructed in 1860 and is considered a valuable addition to Malakoff Diggins State Historic Park. The church was originally situated 15 miles east of North Bloomfield in the town of Birchville and served as a Union Guard Hall where Civil War recruits were trained. Soon thereafter the hall was converted into the Catholic Church as we know it today.

St. Columciles was a disciple of St. Patrick who founded a monastery on an island off the coast of Scotland. He was sent to Scotland from Ireland to christianize the Druids. St. Columcile died and was buried on the Isle of Iona.

The church last held services in the 1950s and was abandoned shortly thereafter. The church was destined to be destroyed until Mr. Bart "Babe" Pinaglia, bought the chapel and donated it to the State of California in 1969. Mr. Pinaglia was a North San Juan businessman who died at the age of 57 and was known affectionately as "Mayor", "Santa", and "Mr. San Juan". He annually held Christmas parties for children in North San Juan. Upon purchase, the structure was beginning to show signs of aging, however the original altar, communion rail, confessional and pews were still in place and in satisfactory condition.

The church was moved to its present site in 1971. It took about two years for state employees to dismantle the old wood frame building and its steeple and rebuild it at the park. The original Catholic Church on this site was almost identical with one more window on each side and a small window behind the alter.

SKIDMORE HOUSE

The Skidmore house was built circa 1862 by Rush Dix Skidmore. "Skid" was born in Versailles, New York, November 23, 1832. In 1854, Skid moved to Nevada City and eventually made his way to North Bloomfield in 1857. In 1857 he took over a bakery business and continued this enterprise until injury to one of his hands, while operating bakery equipment, forced his retirement from this trade. In 1860, he operated a saloon in a two story building on the southeast corner of Mill and Main Street. He purchased that property in 1868. The building burned in the fire of 1876, after which he rebuilt a structure with his saloon business downstairs and a meeting hall upstairs.

On November 1, 1861 Rush Dix Skidmore married Elizabeth Plitch, a native of Germany, in North Bloomfield. Together they had three daughters and two sons. Mr. Skidmore was said to have been one of the wealthier citizens in town. Aside from the saloon trade he charged fees for service as notary public and was an agent for the Eureka and California Stage Lines. Skid ran a stable for the California Stage Line and later financed his son, Grant in the operation of this stable. The stable was located across from his saloon and was previously listed as belonging to estate of J.P. Sims. Skid also had an active interest in mining, and was known to profit from buying and selling claims. He was a mining recorder and was quite a philanthropist in that he oftentimes grubstaked miners less fortunate than he.

Isabel Heffelfinger, resident of North Bloomfield in the early 1900s stated the Skidmore girls were said to be the best dressed girls in the area. "The girls were the apple of R.D. Skidmore's eye and no expense was spared in their attire or education."

Rush Dix Skidmore was always dressed up, always wore a suit and tie, very neat. He was also said to be quite a history buff. Mr. Skidmore died at his home on August 2, 1911.

As you enter the house from the front, the sitting room/office is through the first doorway to your left. This is where the merchant would have conducted his mining transactions and other business matters. The room on your right is the parlor, used to entertain guests. As you walk down the hallway, the bedroom on the left is the Master Bedroom, while the one on the right is the child's bedroom (a daughter). At the end of the hall is the kitchen.

General Information

KINGS SALOON

The original structure was built in 1860 and was operated as an express office. Jack King remodeled this building as a saloon sometime between 1873 and 1875. King was a large, active man and oftentimes took measures into his own hands when drunks became obnoxious. The saloon was believed to be one of seven and perhaps nine saloons in North Bloomfield during its heyday. Saloons were the primary social gathering spots in town for the miners and because of the lack of public entertainment, the proprietors did well financially. North Bloomfield had two beer breweries, the Weise brewery, on the west side of town and the Hieronimus brewery, currently part of the foundation of the former Landsburg residence. Beer was five cents a glass and was the most popular drink since it was so inexpensive. Beer was kept in the basement since refrigeration, as we know it today, was lacking. When the beer supply became low, Mr. King simply disappeared through the trap door and retrieved additional beer from the frigid subterranean room. Locally made beer was served draught style from 5, 10, 15, and 25 gallon barrels. Imported beer was contained in ceramic bottles and was believed to be a bit expensive and subsequently not consumed on a large scale. Hard liquor was not manufactured locally and thus had to be imported from Sacramento or San Francisco. The freight fees incurred from shipping made the cost prohibitive for the miners. A half-pint of whiskey, for example, might cost as much as \$2.00 per bottle. This was near the average miner's daily wage.

There were few women in town and the saloon owners discovered they could attract business by paying women to be present in their establishments to converse with the miners. Some of the saloons in this area were known to pay \$20.00 to \$40.00 a day for this service. If a miner was capable of playing the piano, it afforded him the opportunity to generate some extra income. Tips and free drinks were readily given to those with musical skills.

The Kings Saloon we have in the park today is not an original building. It was reconstructed in 1974 to its original looking condition, based on photographs of the structure that stood on the site. Work was performed by State Park employees and members of E Clampus Vitus Chapter 10 of Nevada City, California.

In relation to old photos of this building and measurements taken from the Sanborn Map, the existing building is somewhat shorter in height and length than the original. This shows the difficulties in making historical reconstructions.

General Information

Malakoff Diggins Statistics

North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company

The company owned 1500 acres total; 1200 of which is mining ground.

348,480,000 cubic yards of auriferous dirt and gravel. At 20 cents per cubic yard, there was a producing capacity of \$69,600,000. Eighty percent of the gold is still present.

Malakoff operation excavated 41 million cubic yards of gravel between 1866 and 1884. This yielded \$3.5 million in gold at \$17 per ounce.

50,000 shares of stock; 45,000 sold at \$30.00 per share.

Hydraulic mining contributed approximately 1/4 of California's gold yield.

Gold was distributed in the gravel on the average of one part in 12 million.

Malakoff Mine Pit

6,800 feet long; 3,800 feet wide and 600 feet deep.

North Bloomfield Tunnel

7,878 feet long; 6 1/2 feet high; 6 feet wide; grade of 4 1/2 feet per 100; shafts average 197 feet deep; situated 200 feet below the Hiller Tunnel.

Bowman Reservoir

Complete in 1876; 96 1/2 feet high; stored 930 million cubic feet or 7 1/2 billion gallons of water; cost \$151,512.44 to build.

Distribution System

43 miles of ditches, flumes, and etc. that cost \$700,000. Employed 800 Chinese and 300 Whites in 1868 to build.

Every foot drop of water in an enclosed pipe creates approximately 1/2 pound of pressure.

General Information

Hydraulic Monitors

500 PSI, 16,000 GPM, 1 million gallons per hour. They used 16 billion gallons per year.

Weighed approximately 1 1/2 tons (Hendy Giant), as many as eight in operation at once.

Washed 50,000 tons of gravel daily.

General Information

TIMELINE: 1850-1859

1850-

The Gold Rush had run its course. Easily attained gold was depleted, and it was considered a good claim if color was found in five or six pans. Wages were down to \$3.00 a day. It had been up to \$20.00 a day in 1848. (see Placer Mining section)

Zachary Taylor is president but dies on July 9 and is succeeded by his vice-president Millard Fillmore.

California admitted as a free state in the Compromise of 1850. Mexican cession to be divided into territories of New Mexico and Utah.

1851-

Gold discovered in Humbug Creek

North Bloomfield settlement begins as a mining camp named "Humbug". Population jumps to 300 almost overnight. (see North Bloomfield Beginnings section)

1852-

Hydraulicking is invented by Matteson, Miller and Chabot (see Invention of Hydraulicking section)

1853-

Sheet-iron pipe introduced and used by R.R. Craig on American Hill in Nevada City.

Franklin Pierce elected fourteenth President.

Lafayette Hotel construction begins. It had a ballroom, saloon and sixteen beds.

1854-

Kansas and Nebraska become U.S. territories. Commodore Perry negotiates a trade treaty with Japan.

Britain and France declare war on Russia; the Crimean War.

1855-

Hotel de France, the second hotel in North Bloomfield, was built next to the Livery Stable. It was 1 1/2 stories and had a canvas roof.

The town begins to develop with houses along both sides of Main Street and many others just off the beaten path.

French forces finally succeed in taking the Malakov Tower in Crimean War in Russia.

1856-

A firm in San Francisco began to manufacture wrought iron pipe for hydraulic mining.

Jacobs and Co. having not enough water for sluicing began to use a rocker and are making \$10 to \$18 dollars a day per person. 9/10/56

Twenty to twenty-five frame houses in Relief Hill with more being built. Two miles east of Humbug and three miles south of Snow Tent.

Blacksmith shop belonging to Joseph Singer (near picnic area) shows up on the delinquent tax roles for Humbug City.

Quitmans lodge #88 (Masonic Temple) was at Orleans Flat. County Court House burns July 19, 1856 destroying all records including the boundary lines of the Eureka Township which included Humbug.

Lafayette Hotel and the Irwin House served as hotels. Two general stores were in existence: Mayhew & Pettijean (location of McKillican and Mobley) and Johns & Taylor. There was also a saw mill in the vicinity of Marten's Ranch (Creegans Sawmill). Franz and Esche built a saloon, later enlarged into a hotel.

As early as 1856, farmers in Marysville were complaining of debris in rivers but because of mining income to the community they built levees to protect farmlands. ✓

1857-

Dr. Mark Emerson became first postmaster of North Bloomfield (Humbug) on June 15. (see Bloomfield Beginnings Section)

Timeline

First public schoolhouse constructed (near the picnic area). U.S. Hotel built and North Bloomfield had connection with North San Juan by daily stage.

Population of town was approximately 500.

Rush Dix Skidmore moves into town and operates a bakery. (see Skidmore House section)

James Buchanan elected the fifteenth U.S. president.

Charles Davis indicted for murder of Louis Miller (Mueller) at Humbug last July. Pled not guilty. Ellen Miller, daughter of deceased, testified Davis asked her father to let her go the circus that evening. Miller refused. Fight started. Both ran outside out of her sight, she heard pistol shots. Miller kept a public house and Davis often ate there. Conversation leading to fight started in barroom. Some testimony that Miller had gun. Mrs. Miller said she heard Davis tell Miller he would shoot him. 2/4/57

Charles Davis sentenced to one year in San Quentin for manslaughter. 10/21/57

Difficulty at ball given at Lafayette House in Humbug between John Enders and Louis Goldberg. Goldberg stabbed Enders in side and victim grabbed knife, trying to pull it out and made wound worse. 12/23/57

Westerfield and Co. in operation next to the U.S. Hotel (at picnic area), selling hats, caps, boots and shoes; gentleman's furnishing goods.

John Enders died at Humbug December 26, 1857. 1/6/58

1858-

North Bloomfield becomes an official townsite and is the center of the Bloomfield township. Included was Relief Hill, Lake City, Derbec, and as far away as North Columbia. Cultural and Industrial Center.

Large stable erected for California Stage Company.

North Bloomfield Livery and Feed Stable operated by J.P. Sims. (located in picnic area)

137 votes cast in North Bloomfield on 8/28/58. Polling place was office of Justice of the Peace, James Holland.

1859-

Timeline

A.L. Smith now owns and runs daily the pony express started by W.J. Westerfield, will serve North Bloomfield.

"The Miners News" the title of a new manuscript paper will be published at North Bloomfield by James Marriot.

Joseph Thomas purchased Humbug Stage Line and now makes regular daily trips to Cherokee, Columbia Hill and Humbug.

School funds for North Bloomfield School with 42 students amounted to \$34.44 (semi-annual fee).

Serious accident at Relief Hill. Jack Wilson, an Englishman, and a Frenchman, Jean Richards, died. Employed by G.K. Reed. Were in tunnel, tapping out clogged shaft when accumulated dirt and water escaped and sluiced them out and down the hillside. Terribly mangled. 6/15/59

Murder suspected. Disappearance of Michael Perfumo, Italian merchant of Humbug. His dog was found shot. 1/29/59

Mr. Franz, resident of Humbug, shot by Mr. Margenburg in Alleghany town. Mr. Franz would not give consent for Margenburg to marry his daughter. 3/2/59

J. Franklin, workman on Magenta Flume was fatally injured last Saturday. Working on ground and 126 feet above him on an aqueduct, a German was at work with a carpenter's chisel. Chisel slipped out of handle and in falling, struck a brace which threw it off at an angle and gave it a rotary motion. Shank struck Franklin just back of left shoulder and came out near left nipple. Chisel lodged in wound. Other workman pulled it out. Dr. R.M. Hunt happened to be in the vicinity, was sent for. Wound bleeding profusely. No hope he would recover. 8/3/59

Constables C.F. Smith and Levi Ayers appointed for the North Bloomfield Township by the board of supervisors.

Malakoff Co. on Virgin Creek cleaned up \$1,200 for three men within a week. They were operating with two pipes and planned to add four more.

North Bloomfield School Census shows 45 children between four and eighteen years old, fifteen below four.

Citizens in western part of Utah Territory trying to form their own territory to be named Nevada. They did not want to be governed by Mormons.

Oregon becomes U.S. state.

Timeline

TIMELINE: 1860-1869

1860-

U.S. census shows 784 inhabitants of North Bloomfield. Abraham Lincoln elected U.S. president.

Lathaw inaugurated as governor on January 16th, a democrat, pro-slavery. In office only a short time when he applied for and received an appointment to the U.S. Senate to fill the vacancy of Senator Broderick killed by Judge Terry in a duel on 9/13/59.

Tragedy strikes North Bloomfield. The exhaustion of surface claims and shortage of water due to drought conditions causes the exodus of miners to Nevada's Washoe county and the silver-mines. A depression set into North Bloomfield.

Skidmore operates a two-story saloon on the corner of Relief Hill Rd and North Bloomfield Rd. (see Skidmore House section)

Building on the site of the Kings Saloon was constructed as an express office.

Lake City booming with hotel, french restaurant, several houses, and grocery store. A lake owned by the Eureka Lake and Miner's Ditch Company is part of the sub-division.

A common miner by the name of Julius Poquillion purchased several placer mining claims at depression prices. He soon owns 1535 contiguous acres.

Many vacant houses in North Bloomfield. General store owned by Brownell (formerly Mayhew and Pettijean, presently McKillican and Mobley) and Bakery owned by Skidmore.

Frenchman named Alphone Baptist, working in a tunnel near North Bloomfield injured by discharge of dynamite. Set charge and lit fuse, left tunnel. After 15 minutes Baptist went back into tunnel. Dynamite exploded in his face. Still alive. 1/1/60

On July 22, at Humbug, difficulty arose between Mr. Monier and an Italian named Castania. The Italian stabbed Monier. Examined before Justice Marriott and bail set at \$4,000. Assault with intent to commit murder. Monier recovered. On August 3rd, Italian stabbed by Monier's wife with kitchen knife. Woman not arrested. 8/8/60

A trial for the Italian, Castania, who stabbed Monier at North Bloomfield held on Saturday. Jury out four hours. Verdict -- acquittal. Indictment against Mrs. Monier dismissed on motion of District Attorney. 9/19/60

Man named LeBlanc was shot and killed in mining claims of Chas Hakell near Arnolds Ranch (Lake City) last Wednesday. Shot by S.T. Nipher, night watchman. Accomplice arrested at Humbug. LeBlanc, native of Canada, was 28 and had been living around North Bloomfield for six or seven months without visible means of support. Entered tunnel equipped with flour sack, scoop, brush, candles, matches, bowie knife and pistol. Nipher questioned and released. 11/3/60

Skidmore House is built. (see Skidmore House section)

Senators Gwin, Lathan and Lane announced in the U.S. Senate that under certain conditions the western states would set up their own independent government. The editor believed that Oregon and California would remain loyal to the Union. Secession of the south appearing more and more possible.

Humbug Flume some 2000 ft long was completed after four years of work. It was owned by Dr. Hiller. This allowed the independent mining companies to move their tailings down the Humbug drainage after flowing through the Hiller Tunnel.

1861-

North Bloomfield school attendance approximately 40.

Civil War begins when Mississippi, Florida, Alabama, Georgia, Louisiana, Texas, Virginia, Tennessee, Arkansas, and North Carolina secede from the union.

Lake City has A-1 hotel, two stores, large french restaurant, hose factory, sawmill, mechanics shop, express office, and coming soon a Catholic church. 1/19/61

A patriotic Union Club was organized at North Bloomfield to show support for the federal government and constitution. Showed disdain for the idea of forming a pacific republic. Recognized only the Stars and Stripes. 5/18/61

Dr. Hiller, at his mining claim, is "using four pipes, each having a fall or pressure of 180 feet perpendicular and with which he seems to be purging the very bowels of the terrestrial globe". 6/15/61

Lorenzo Sawyer in Nevada City. Formerly practiced law in that place. Left there in 1853, lived five or six years in S.F. and had a practice there. Spent past two years in Illinois. 6/18/61

Timeline

1862-

Rush Dix Skidmore marries Elizabeth Plitch in North Bloomfield on 5/27/62.
(see Skidmore House section)

The Federal ironclad Monitor engaged the Merrimac in naval warfare. A monitor was a revolving gun turret.

Homestead Act served to displace the Plains Indians and develop the western states.

Union and Central Pacific Railways are chartered and given large land grants by Congress.

1863-

Town population rapidly declining, nearly depopulated.

1864-

The thirteenth amendment is passed prohibiting slavery.

1865-

Lincoln is assassinated on April 14.

1866-

Poquillion succeeded in attracting investors and formed the North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company. The company soon owned 1535 acres and brought in the not yet highly refined monitors and proceeded to work the claims. The yield was 13 cents per cubic yard of gravel. Water was plentiful, as there had been over 100 inches of rainfall this past year and the North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company managed to show a profit its first year.

A real duel -- Two Frenchmen, residing at North Bloomfield fought a duel near that place Sunday last. Dispute arose between Souchett and Picard in relation to an account of \$14.00, which the former claimed to have against the latter. Challenge was accepted. Preliminaries arranged, weapons chosen, Colt six shooters. Principals and Seconds repaired to the field, the latter, desiring to prevent effusion of blood, capped weapons. Loaded then with ball, no powder. Principals stationed. Discovered trick of seconds. Determined to fight without Seconds. Pistols loaded and parties repaired to field alone. At 25 paces fight began, parties firing rapidly and advancing. One fired six shots, the other five, the

Timeline

cap snapping in one case. Souchett advanced upon his antagonist and beat him over the head until he was nearly dead. Picard had a gash around the head which might have been made by a ball. Save this, neither injured by shooting. Picard almost insensible from effects of whipping. 9/26/66

Souchett and Picard, two Frenchmen who dueled at North Bloomfield, arrested and taken before Justice Carter on Tuesday. Tried upon two charges. 1) "Unlawfully assembled together by previous agreement and fighting to the great terror of the citizens of the town of North Bloomfield and to the great terror to the citizens of this state, with pistols loaded with powder and leaden bullets, the place where they were assembled being a public place." Sentenced to several days in county jail. 2) Charged with assault. Picard got 20 days, Souchett 21 days. 9/27/66

Alaska purchased for \$7,200,000 March 30.

1868-

North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company purchased the Rudyard or English Dam at the head of the middle fork of the Yuba River, then the largest reservoir in California. This was actually three dams made of stone and wood. The highest dam was 125 feet wide, spanning the south fork of the Yuba River. A ditch ran 80 miles to the mines below. Shortly thereafter, they purchased the Bowman ranch; 160 acres surrounded by mountains on three sides. The North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company constructed the first dam of Bowman Lake originally 65 feet high and 215 feet long using trees, mud and rock. (see Water Supply Systems)

The NBGMC employed 60 to 80 men. Fifty men were digging a ditch from Poorman's Creek 24 miles long just past Snow Tent. 8/27/68

Thursday, the NBGMC expect to have 500 chinese working on ditch. Company sometime since bought a number of mining claims near North Bloomfield. On Tuesday last, filed articles of incorporation with the Secretary of State with capital stock fixed a \$800,000 in 8,000 shares. 9/3/68

1869-

Transcontinental Railway completed May 10.

Ulysses S. Grant elected eighteenth U.S. president.

Prohibition Party first organized in U.S.

Wyoming first state to institute women's suffrage.

Timeline

Fire at North Bloomfield, originated in stable belonging to Skidmore, spread to United States Hotel, kept by J.B. Henry, and to store and dwelling of C. Nash family. Family left destitute.

1/17/69

Exhibition by school children of North Bloomfield earned \$162 with an expense of \$30. A.A. Smith was teacher. 2/22/69

NBGMC will soon extend their ditch to Big Canyon Creek, Keep eight pipes going. Company has purchased Bowman's Ranch and proposes to erect a damn this summer. 4/11/69

TIMELINE: 1870-1879

1870-

Hamilton Smith Jr. designed the Bowman Ditch which was finished on September 15, 1870. (see Water Supply Systems)

The McKillican-Mobley store building was given the side storehouse addition by T.P. Crandal in 1870. (see McKillican-Mobley Store section)

Ostrom set up his Livery Stable in a building built in the 1850s.

Within the next four years, the North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company grossed \$494,250 at approximately 15 cents per cubic yard of material. 3 1/4 million cubic yards of material were excavated. In any given 18 months, there was enough material moved to fill the Erie Canal.

U.S. Census, North Bloomfield 636.

1871-

During the next nine years, Hydraulic mining produced 121 million dollars, more than half the total gold yielded in the state of California.

1872-

Hamilton Smith engineered the North Bloomfield Drain Tunnel, 7,878 feet in length and 200 feet below the Hiller tunnel to bedrock. (see Drain Tunnels)

A.A. Smith buys the corner lot on Relief Hill Rd. (see Smith-Knotwell Drugstore section)

At this time in North Bloomfield there was butcher shop, a blacksmith, a brewery, and a billiards saloon.

1873-

New schoolhouse erected at cost of \$3,700. Original price was to be \$2,900 but the contractor went over cost and the townspeople decided to raise the extra money by increasing their own taxes. Religious services were held on weekends. (see North Bloomfield School section)

Kings Saloon moves into the express office building. (see Kings Saloon Section)

The North Bloomfield Drain Tunnel is completed on November 17. (see Drain Tunnel section)

Silver discoveries in Nevada.

Francis Blain (Blair) loses agricultural claim to land that was needed by the NBGMC. Adolphus Lind the superintendent of the NBGMC was put in charge of the new land and was moved into Blain's house as caretaker. One March evening after leaving a saloon to head home, he was murdered. Four shots fired, a cry heard, found with four gunshot wounds, and a hatchet wound to the head. Suspicion fell on Blain and he was arrested. Indicted by a grand jury in May but acquitted by jury in 4/25/74. Built a house on upper end of his property where Jeffer's rental was.

Seventy-one students at North Bloomfield School. Quarterly apportionment by state \$106.50.

Stores, saloons, business houses, dwellings and a large hotel being built at Malakoff. This was a new section of North Bloomfield.

Ed Cummings builds a saloon and adds the dance hall in 1878.

1874-

Washburn and Pillsbury introduce the process of reducing wheat to flour by the use of chilled steel rollers.

North Bloomfield has population of 500. This includes five hotels, eight saloons, two dry goods stores, two grocery stores, three lodging houses, one lunch house, one brewery, one barbershop, one blacksmith, one butchershop, three bootmakers, one bakery, two livery stables, one post office, three express offices, one physician, one drugstore, one dentist, one notary public, one justice of the peace, one lodge of Redmen, one lodge of Templars, a tri-weekly stage from North San Juan to North Bloomfield and a daily stage to and from Moores Flat and Nevada City.

A.A. Smith is Justice of the Peace.

1875-

Because of tremendous amounts of water discharged through monitors, the Yuba and Feather Rivers flooded Marysville and Yuba City, resulting in a serious loss of lives.

For the next six years, continuous court battles in progress, farmers with injunctions against miners and mining companies with over-rulings of these injunctions.

Peter Lund who was operating the Esche and Franz saloon, moved to Relief Hill with his family and opened a boarding house. The saloon was sold to Carion and Buga of North San Juan. For some reason Lund soon returned to operate the saloon and enlarged it into the North Bloomfield Hotel.

Boarding house at shaft #6 operated by George Edwards burned to the ground. He moved into town and built the three-story Grand Central Hotel next to the General Store.

First U.S. factory to use Bessemer steel-making process built by Andrew Carnegie.

1876-

Levees were built around Marysville to protect the city and farm fields from floods. It became known as "The Walled City".

In May, the French Hotel, containing Penlon's saloon, burned to the ground. (The saloon was heavily insured at the time and the fire was believed to be arson.) The fire burned from the Zigenhein house to Relief Hill Road. It burned the Helwig's butchershop, Dr. Farley's office, the McKillican's storehouse and the Skidmore Saloon, among others. Skidmore later rebuilds a two story structure (see Skidmore House section). In October, another fire burns the Hotel de France (next to the livery stable). A man by the name of Harmon lost his life and it was supposed that he was the cause of the fire since he had the habit of smoking a pipe while lying in bed.

A.A. Smith builds Drug Store. (see Smith-Knotwell Drugstore section)

North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company is now in full operation. Seven "CRAIG" monitors (similar to Hendy Giants) with up to 8" diameters in use 24 hours a day. Miners worked a twelve hour shift, 6 to 6 and at night used kerosene lanterns with large reflectors and pitch torches. A well paid miner earned \$2.50 a day or just about 21 cents an hour.

Patent granted for the manufacture of barbed wire.

First intelligible sentence transmitted by telephone by Alexander Graham Bell.

Colorado becomes a U.S. state.

Timeline

1877-

Rutherford B. Hayes elected nineteenth president of U.S.

The phonograph patented by Thomas A. Edison.

1878-

Ed Cummins added a large room to his saloon to be used for dancing, social events and theatrical presentations.

Ridge Telephone Company organized in North San Juan. Owned by Milton Water and Mining Company, North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company and Eureka Lake and Yuba Canal Company. The line cost \$6,000, and was 60 miles long with 22 stations. Used in management of ditches and claims.

The Anti-Debris Association was formed and soon petitions were submitted to the legislature, requesting laws to control mining operations.

A survey by state engineers shows 18,000 acres of once fertile farmland was buried by mining debris.

The arc light introduced by C.F. Bush.

1879-

Thomas A. Edison invented the incandescent electric light, maintaining incandescence for over 40 hours.

The community all along San Juan Ridge was shook by news of the brutal murder of banker William F. Cummings of Moores Flat. The stage that day was heavily loaded. Cummings was believed to have been carrying \$7,000 in gold. Cummings occupied the front seat with Matt Daily, the driver. Two bandits held up the stage. One armed with a double barrel shotgun, lined up the passengers and searched them for weapons or valuables. The robbers grabbed Cumming's valise and a scuffle ensued. As the bandit and Cummings rolled upon the ground the other bandit with a shotgun endeavored to get a shot at Cummings. The man with the shotgun shot and killed Cummings at close range. The stage was held up at Rock Creek, three miles north of Nevada City. The robbers, John Collins, a San Quentin parolee, and Charles Thorne were arrested in the east by Lees and Aull. They were arrested in the fall of 1882 and returned to Nevada City. Thorne was sentenced to life in San Quentin in 1883 and Collins was hung in the jailyard at Nevada City on February 1, 1884. 10/1/79

Timeline

TIMELINE: 1880-1889

1880-

Electric lights were installed in the mine that were powered by a hydraulic generator. Possibly driven by a Pelton Wheel which was manufactured in Nevada City. This of course was much more efficient in lighting the Diggins at night than previous methods. Malakoff was now using 160 million gallons of water in a 24 hour period.

White population was 1,279.

John Knotwell becomes partner in Smith-Knotwell Drug Store. (see Smith-Knotwell Drug Store section)

Since 1860, there has been 6500 miles of ditches built for hydraulic mining purposes statewide.

1881-

Hydraulic mines along the Yuba and Feather Rivers were ordered to shut down by the court in order to study the effects of mining on these rivers. Miners went to farmlands in search of employment. Merchants in the area suffered because of dwindling population and began boycotting valley goods.

John Knotwell marries Nettie Smith the daughter of A.A. Smith on July 20. (see Smith-Knotwell Drug Store section)

1882-

Miners have invested \$110,000,000 for hydraulic mining.

Mining companies proposed compromise, such as building debris dams if farmers will drop the legal proceedings. The farmers wanted no part of this. Some of the larger mining operations built these debris dams.

September of 1882 "Woodruff vs. North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company" Judge Lorenzo Sawyer stated, "Debris in rivers is from ALL hydraulic mines not just one". Sawyer made several trips to North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company and other mines and found the debris dams already overflowing.

About a week ago Pierre David, who had long been in the employ of North Bloomfield Company, was at work when a portion of a log that he had chopped, rolled upon him and broke one of his legs. It was subsequently found necessary

to amputate the injured limb and at 8:00 P.M. Saturday the unfortunate man died.
12/13/82

1883-

English Dam (first reservoir purchased by the North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company) was inspected and found to be in excellent shape, no leaks, weak points etc. Three days later the dam broke releasing millions of acre feet of water down the Middle Fork of the Yuba. Sabotage was suspected but never proven. Milton Mining Company season water supply was lost (subsidiary of North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company) and property damage suits left this subsidiary company bankrupt.

1884-

January 7th - Sawyer Decision on Woodruff Case - this did not close down hydraulic mining, however it did impose strict laws regarding debris and did close all loop-holes. All tailings must stop. This decision was 225 pages long.

In January of this year, one month's clean-up was over \$114,000 dollars at \$17.00 an ounce. At \$350 an ounce that would be \$2.35 million.

A.W. Smith stabbed Antonio Barteldo twice. 10/22/84

Andrew Trottier, employed at Derbec Drift Mine, ignited four dynamite blasts. Only three exploded and he returned to ascertain what prevented the fourth. Just as he stooped over it the charge went off, killing him instantly. 12/13/84

1886-

North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company found in contempt as they had been operating their monitors at night and were fined heavily. North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company installed an elevator system that would pull debris from the tailings and retain it in holding ponds. This extra step in the process hindered greatly the production capabilities, reducing the profit margin. It did however satisfy the Sawyer Decision.

TIMELINE: 1890-1930

1890-

North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company, the Alpha Omega Mine and mines in Washington are hydraulic mines on the South Fork of the Yuba River in accordance with Sawyer.

1891-

Congress passes the "CAMINETTI LAW". All hydraulic mines must be licensed. North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company at this time was in accordance with Sawyer so they disregarded this new law and did not file for a license.

1896-

U.S. District Court declares mining without this permit was illegal, North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company once again found in contempt and fined heavily. At this point litigation had been immensely expensive and had depleted a large amount of the companies assets.

Malakoff closes sometime in the late 1890s. The North Bloomfield Gravel Mining Company was unincorporated in 1910. Landsburg and other locals in the period between 1910 and 1930, "bootleg operated" the mine for a few months. They had no ownership or authorization.

1911-

Rush Dix Skidmore dies on August 2. (see Skidmore House section)

Gold Rush Vocabulary

Amalgam

- an alloy of gold and silver and/or other metals that are mixed with mercury.

Assayer

- a person that evaluated the mineral content of ore by chemical analysis.

Bar

- a bank of sand or gravel that extends into a river.

Bonanza

- a rich body of ore, below or above ground level.

Bullion

- melted gold made into bricks or bars.

Claim

- a piece of land legally held for mining, the location of which is officially recorded and marked by monuments.

Claim jumping

- taking over a claim staked out by someone else.

Cradle

- another name for a rocker box.

Cleaning-up

- the separation of gold from the debris in the bottom of the sluice box.

Dredge

- a large raft or barge on which are mounted either a chain of buckets or suction pumps or other appliance, to bring up and wash river deposits and gravel for gold.

Dust

- minute particles of gold taken by placer mining.

Flume

- wooden aqueduct for diverting river water or carrying water long distances.

Gulch

- a deep narrow valley or ravine.

Hydraulicking

- process by which a bank of gold-bearing earth and rock is excavated by a jet of water shot out of a hydraulic monitor.

Lode

- a large vein of ore-bearing rock.

Long tom

- a long sluice box.

Monitor

- a metal high-pressure water nozzle mounted on a swivel and used for hydraulic mining.

Mother lode

- a mile wide belt of gold producing country 120 miles long along the Sierra foothills.

Nugget

- a lump of gold.

Pan

- a shallow metal dish for washing gold-bearing earth.

Placer

- a place where gold is obtained by washing.

Pocket

- a small amount of gold-bearing gravel in one place.

Quartz

- a whitish mineral that sometimes contains gold.

Quicksilver

- Mercury, used to separate gold by making an amalgam.

Riffle

- the lining in the bottom of a sluice made of wood or stones used to trap gold-bearing material.

Rocker box

- a short sluice box made to rock back and forth while loose material and water is added to help separate out the gold.

Run

- the period of operating a sluice box between clean-ups.

Sluice box

- a long narrow box with raised portions on the bottom to catch gold as loose material is washed down the box with running water.

Strike

- a new found concentration of gold.

Tailings

- the left over material after washing gold from ground ore.

Vein

- a zone or belt of rock clearly separate from surrounding rock.

Colorful Vocabulary

Here is a list of terms and phrases that you might have heard if you were living in the 1850s. The students might like to write a story or skit using as many terms as possible. They could read the story during your overnight stay.

By the great horned spoon!

Flatulent balderdash! (unbelievable!)

Sir/Madam

Swop lies (tell stories)

There's not as that man has said that insent true! (He tells the truth)

How passed the night? (good morning)

Yon- house, man, bridge, etc. (that- house, etc)

Down yonder, over yonder (over there)

Vixen, Hussey (bad woman)

Frisco (San Francisco)

Trundle along (roll along slowly)

Chinee (chinese man)

Stand aside sir! (get out of the way)

Whilst (while)

Disremember (to forget)

He's an old wa haws (he is an old war horse)

Rally 'round (gather around)

Fallacious (false, deceptive)

I have a concern thereto... (I worry about...)

Let's plump him up a bit. (slap him around)

Fortnight (two weeks)

I reckon, I allow as how (I guess)

ain't, hain't (am/are not)

Hells bells!, Tarnation!, By dang! (wow!)

Horse manure!, Hogwash!, Bull! (no way!)

Indeed! (totally!)

Hereabouts (around here)

A blowhard (a braggart)

High-fallutin

Honeyfogle (cheat)

Gag (joke)

Josh, kid (to joke)

Wet my whistle (get a drink)

Bar keep, bartender

Spirits, alcohol, rot gut, red eye, coffin varnish, eye opener, night cap

The blues, the jimjams, the shakes (alcohol overdose)

The Elephant



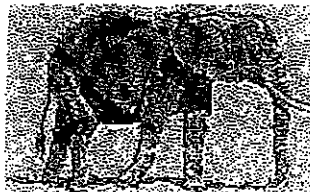
*I think that I may without vanity affirm that I have
"seen the elephant."*

- Louisa Clapp

To forty-niners and those following, no expression characterized the California gold rush more than the words "seeing the elephant." Those planning to travel west announced they were "going to see the elephant." Those turning back claimed they had seen the "elephant's tracks" or the "elephant's tail," and confessed they'd seen more than enough of the animal.

The expression predated the gold rush, arising from a tale current when circus parades first featured elephants. A farmer, so the story went, hearing that a circus was in town, loaded his wagon with vegetables for the market there. He had never seen an elephant and very much wished to. On the way to town he encountered the circus parade, led by an elephant. The farmer was thrilled. His horses, however, were terrified. Bolting, they overturned the wagon and ruined the vegetables. "I don't give a hang," the farmer said, "for I have seen the elephant."

For gold rushers, the elephant symbolized both the high cost of their endeavor — the myriad possibilities for misfortune on the journey or in California — and, like the farmer's circus elephant, an exotic sight, and unequalled experience, the adventure of a lifetime.



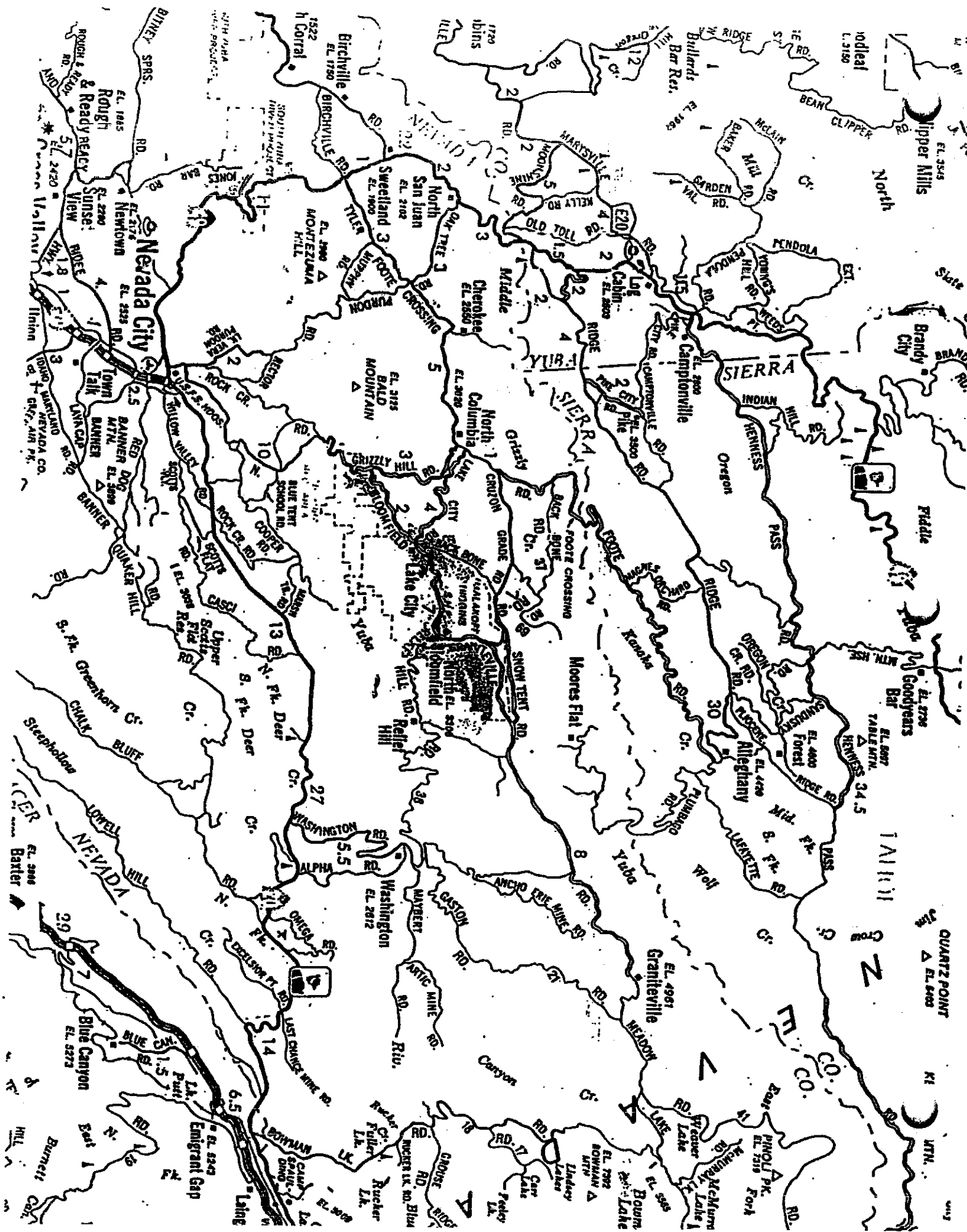


In the Gold Fields — Words to Know

<i>Alcalde</i>	the mayor or the judge
<i>bar</i>	sand built up at the bend of a river
<i>Batea</i>	a flat Indian bowl used by miners when they did not have a meal pan
<i>boom town</i>	a town that grew fast, generally as a result of mining
<i>cradle</i>	a device to separate rock and gravel from gold
<i>dry diggings</i>	mining down without water; digging gold out of cracks in the rocks or from dry river beds
<i>ghost town</i>	a town where few, if any, people live
<i>grubstake</i>	a loan of food until the miner could repay
<i>hopper</i>	a part of a cradle rocker
<i>lode</i>	vein or deposit of gold
<i>Mother Lode</i>	vein or deposit of gold running through quartz in the Sierra Nevada Mountains
<i>nuggets</i>	lumps of gold in various sizes and weights
<i>"pay dirt"</i>	clay, sand or gravel with gold in it
<i>poke</i>	bag used to carry gold dust or nuggets
<i>quartz</i>	a mineral or rock in which gold may be found
<i>stake a claim</i>	marking the boundary line of a miner's property with a stake or a pile of rocks
<i>tailing</i>	the waste pile of rocks and gravel after washing the gold
<i>wet diggings</i>	mining where there is water; digging for gold from rivers or streams

Expressions in the Gold Field

<i>"color"</i>	any trace of gold found
<i>"come down with the dust"</i>	pay cash at the time of purchase
<i>"pan out"</i>	gold played out or gone
<i>"seeing the elephant"</i>	seeing gold in the gold field
<i>"throw down the box"</i>	term used by robbers when they held up a stagecoach; it refers to the box that holds the gold
<i>"whip"</i>	driver of the stagecoach



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[Home](#)[Students](#)[Teachers](#)[Research](#)[Sitemap](#)

Keyword Search

Teacher Information - Hydraulic Mining

[← Go Back](#)

Hydraulic mining was a California invention. It worked well here because the snow melts in the spring and summer gave the miners a good supply of water. The decision to curtail hydraulic mining was the point where agriculture became California's main industry. Current court cases still refer to the decision of 1884 because it established case law regulating upstream activities as they relate to downstream outcomes. Hydraulic mining had serious consequence for the inhabitants of the Central Valley of California. The "slickens" (sand and particulate matter suspended in the water) filled streambeds and caused serious flooding in the Central Valley towns. The flooding of Marysville and Sacramento in the 1860s was due, in part, to the filling of the riverbeds. Near Marysville, the riverbed was filled to the top of the banks, causing flooding of the nearby towns and farms. This transfer of earth was one of the greatest in human history. The filling of the rivers crippled water transportation and caused extreme hardship on the farming interests. Finally, in 1884, a court decision enjoined the miners from discharging their debris into the rivers. Hydraulic mining also caused great damage to the environment of the gold country. The water cannons blasted dirt and rocks away. The larger rocks stayed nearby, while the dirt and sands were washed into the valley rivers. The rivers of the area had as much as 200 feet of tailings in their beds. The landscape was permanently changed. Today, one can visit Malakoff Diggings State Park and see the results of hydraulic mining. The flumes and ditches for carrying the water were eventually used for irrigation and later for generating electricity. The Pacific Gas and Electric Company (PG&E) bought many mining water ditch companies when it began making electricity near the turn of the century. Many of the ditches are still in use for that purpose.

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Keyword Search

Explanation of Hydraulic Mining

[<-- Go Back](#)

By far the most efficient system of mining yet known, for hill diggings, is the hydraulic; for the discovery of which California is indebted to Mr. Edward E. Matteson....Mr. M. first commenced the use of this method at American Hill, Nevada, in February, 1852, and such was the success attending its operation that others around him immediately began to adopt it; and it is now in general use throughout the mining districts of the State....Water being conveyed....by canals and ditches, around and among the hills and mountains sides where mining is carried on, it is distributed from the main canal by smaller ditches to mining claims requiring it. Here it is run from the small ditch into a trough fixed upon tressel work, which is often technically termed the "Hydraulic Telegraph;" or, run in heavy duck hose upon the ground, to the edge and down the almost perpendicular bank to the bed rock, or bottom of the claim, where it lies coiled about on the rock and the dirt like a huge serpent. As the upper end of the hose is much larger than the lower end, the water running in, keeps it full to the very top; and the weight of this water escaping through a pipe attached to the lower end of the hose, in a similar manner to a fire engine, plays upon the bank with great effect, washing it rapidly away....The most efficient manner of washing down these banks is by undermining them near the bed rock, when large masses - frequently many tons in weight - "cave down" and not only break themselves to pieces by the fall, but unfortunately often bury the too venturesome miner beneath them. It is in the is kind of mining so many accidents have occurred....Sometimes when a man has been covered up by a bank falling upon him, not only the stream generally used in the claim, but often the entire contents of the ditch are thus turned on, and with the assistance of every miner who knows of the accident, it is used for sluicing him out, and which is far the speediest and best means for his deliverance. One becomes surprised when looking at the bold and defiant strength of a miner's will and purpose, and the risk he so often runs, that comparatively so few accidents of this kind occur. By care however, this branch of mining can be conducted with the same safety as any other. The "hydraulic process" removes and washes masses of earth that would otherwise be useless and its working unprofitable, thus making it not only one of the most useful and effectual, but almost an indispensable method of mining for gold in California. (Hutchings California Magazine, September, 1860)

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[Home](#)[Students](#)[Teachers](#)[Research](#)[Sitemap](#)

Keyword Search

Effects of Hydraulic Mining 1

[← Go Back](#)

Ditches, from miles back in the mountains, bring the water up against the hillside [near Douglas City on the Trinity River], far above the surface of the flat, and a flume, or "raceway," brings the water directly over the "claim." A very stout hose, often six inches in diameter, conducts the nozzle like that of a fire engine, only larger. Now, this stream of water, heavy and issuing with enormous force from the great pressure so high a head of water, is made to play against this bank of hard earth, which melts away before it like sand, and all flows into the sluices - mud, bowlders, gold. The mud is carried off in the stream of thick, muddy water; the bowlders, if not too large, roll down with the swift current; the heavier gold falls in the crevices and is dissolved in the quicksilver, as sugar or salt would in water. In some mines these sluices are miles long, and are charged with quicksilver by the thousands of pounds. This washing down banks by such a stream of water under pressure is "hydraulic mining." After a certain time the sluices are "cleaned up," that is, the blocks are removed, the quicksilver, amalgamated with the gold, is taken out, the former being then driven off by heat - "retorted" - and the gold left....The amount of soil removed by hydraulic mining must be seen to be at all appreciated. Single claims will estimate it by the millions of tons, the "tailings" (refuse from the sluices) fill valleys, while the mud not only muddies the Sacramento River for more than four hundred miles of its course, but is slowly and surely filling up the Bay of San Francisco. In the Sierra, the soil from hundreds of acres together has already been sluiced off the rock, which it formerly covered even to the depth of 150 feet! William Brewer, October, 1862)

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Keyword Search

Effects of Hydraulic Mining 2

[← Go Back](#)

By no other means does man more completely change the face of nature than by this process of hydraulic mining. Hills melt away and disappear under its influence, every winter's freshets carrying to lower and yet lower points portions of the detritus, while whole valleys are filled with clean washed boulders of quartz and other rocks. Meanwhile the Sacramento and its branches, as well as the San Joaquin, flow turbid with mud. Bars are formed where none existed before, and the hydrography of the Bay of San Francisco is changing under the influence of the same causes. (Titus Cronise, 1868)

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Effects of Hydraulic Mining 3

[<-- Go Back](#)

Tornado, flood, earthquake and volcano combined could hardly make greater havoc, spread wider ruin and wreck, than are to be seen everywhere in the track of the larger gold-washing operations. None of the interior streams of California, though naturally pure as crystal, escape the change to a thick yellow mud from this cause, early in their progress from the hills....Thousands of acres of fine land along their banks are ruined forever by deposits of this character. A farmer may have his whole estate turned into a barren waste by a flood of sand and gravel from some hydraulic mining up stream; more, if a fine orchard or garden stands in the way of the working of a rich gulch or bank, orchard or garden must go. Then the tornout, dugout, washed to pieces and then washed over sidehills, masses that have been or are being subjected to hydraulics of the miners, are the very devil's chaos indeed. The country is full of them among the mining districts of the Sierra Nevada, and they are truly the terrible blot upon the face of Nature. (Samuel Bowles, 1868)

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Keyword Search

Effects of Hydraulic Mining 4

[<-- Go Back](#)

If you visit Marysville....drive out fifteen miles to Smartsville or Timbuctoo. You pass within sight of a classic locality - Yuba Dam; and you see and are made to understand what, until I saw it I could not entirely comprehend - the whole practice of hydraulic-mining....At Smartsville, Timbuctoo, and Rose's Bar I suppose they wash into the sluices half a dozen acres a day, from fifty to two hundred feet deep; and in the muddy torrent, which rushes down at railroad speed through the channels prepared for it, you may see large rocks helplessly rolling along....Of course the acres washed away must go somewhere, and they are filling up the Yuba River. This was once, I am told by old residents, a swift and clear mountain torrent; it is now a turbid, and not rapid stream, whose bed has been raised by the washings of the miners not less than fifty feet above its level in 1849. It once contained trout, but now I imagine a catfish would die in it. (Charles Nordhoff, 1872)

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[Home](#)[Students](#)[Teachers](#)[Research](#)[Site Map](#)

Keyword Search

Governor's Message of 1881

[← Go Back](#)

The principle of community of interest, which underlies and pervades the whole economic system of American government, cannot be ignored in a case of this magnitude, nor should there, on the other hand, be any doubt in the public mind as to the justice of application. To prove the interest of the State in the matter, it will probably suffice to demonstrate that it has as much to gain by the successful cure of the debris evil, and much to loss by the failure of all attempts in that direction....Should the Legislature determine to refuse all further aid to the engineering works proposed, and should the debris consequently be permitted to flow on without interruption, we have the judgement of the engineers to the effect that the Sacramento Valley will, at no distant date, be rendered uninhabitable; that the rivers will cease to be navigable; that the Cities of Marysville, Sacramento, and Colusa (the latter by floods), together with the towns in between and around them, will be overwhelmed; and that all practical purposes of producing wealth, and supporting the government, this section of the State will be blotted out....The main duty of the hour – the relief of the State from the perils with which it is now threatened by the results of hydraulic mining – is my chief concern in addressing you....I will conclude by expressing the hope that your honorable bodies may so appreciate the urgency and gravity of the emergency as to adopt legislation which will meet the utmost requirements of the case; which will provide for the prosecution of such remedial works as shall restore the carrying capacity and navigability of our waterways; deliver the farmers of the upper Sacramento from destruction by detritus, and farmers of the lower Sacramento from destruction by floods; enable our rivers to carry their highest floodwaters without injury or danger to the country and the cities past which they flow; preserve the navigability of our river system as highways of commerce; remove all apprehensions concerning the Bay of Suisun and the Harbor of San Francisco; and at the same time permit the continuance of those mining operations which add so largely to the wealth of the community and support so considerable a percentage of the population. (Governor George Perkins' special message to the California legislature, January 13, 1881)

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[Home](#)[Students](#)[Teachers](#)[Research](#)[Sitemap](#)[Keyword Search](#)

Miner's Testimony

[← Go Back](#)

The great evil of which complaint is made, to wit, filling our lower rivers, bays, and harbor, arises from and upon a much larger area than that operated upon by the hydraulic miners, and is very much more extensive and should not be charged upon the miners at all. It cannot be denied that much the largest portion of the immediate damage to the farmers near, or at the mouths of these mining rivers 9by covering their lands with "slickens"), is due to mining operations, yet even this is not due to mining alone. This class of damage is local, and can, without doubt, be grappled with and justice be done to both miners and farmers, and the evil itself, in a great measure cured, by utilizing this "slickens" in filling up land, and making valuable that which is now considered worthless. This cannot be done by legislation, aided and guided by information and results which can only be arrived at by a "non-partisan" commission of scientific men, free from all local influences and interests, who shall make this examination a speciality, until the subject is exhausted. The great evil, charged upon the hydraulic miners alone, of the filling up of the lower rivers, bays, and harbor arises from two causes....First, natural ones; and second, principally from the operations of the farmers themselves in following their agricultural interests. (Testimony given by Lester Robinson, mine owner, before California legislative hearing, 1878)

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[Home](#)[Students](#)[Teachers](#)[Research](#)[Site map](#)

Keyword Search

Report of Legislature

[<-- Go Back](#)

Mr. Speaker: Your Committee on mining Debris....have taken voluminous testimony touching the subject matter of the investigation....At the date of the early settlement of the State the water of the Sacramento and its tributaries was entirely free from the detritus with which it has become heavily charged since hydraulic mining was introduced to the mountains....Debris from the mines has not only filled up the channels of the Yuba, Bear, and Feather Rivers....but also as to thereby causes the destruction of thousands of acres of most valuable farming lands....Fertile farms, immense orchards, blooming gardens, costly improvements, and homes happy with all the surroundings that embellish communities and enrich a State - all are engulfed in a common destruction, and their owners have gone out bankrupted from the merciless invasion of a foe that has left them penni-less....None will underrate the value to a community of those who assail mountain sides with the energy that brooks no obstacle, and an enterprise that laughs at any expense - looking only at the achievements of science and the victories of skill which tear them from their foundations and pour millions of wealth into the lap of the world. Yet the vanquished mountain, like a sullen foe, turns with relentless fury upon the plain and destroys it, and at every flood, like an angry tide, it goes on widening and deepening until nothing is left to destroy. (Majority Report of the Legislative Committee on Mining Debris, 1878)

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Keyword Search

Miner's Rights Article

[<-- Go Back](#)

The farmers of the valleys....fail to remember that they located down on those farms after the miners had acquired rights above on the streams. Among the rights acquired by the miners was that of "dumpage" into the tributaries of the rivers....Those afflicted by the tailings must hunt up some other remedy beside that of stopping mining. (Grass Valley Daily Union, January, 1876)

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[Home](#)

[Students](#)

[Teachers](#)

[Research](#)

[Sitemap](#)

Keyword Search

Farmers Statement

[← Go Back](#)

I have no objection to miners digging out all the gold they can find, but I don't want them to send the whole side of a hill down upon my ranch and bury me and all I have. And that is just what they have done and are doing. I want to be let alone. I don't know much about law nor don't want to. If it is the law that one man shall use his property so as not injure his neighbor, I shall like to see that law put in force.
(James Keyes, farmer, 1874)

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R N C A L I F O R N I A . O R G

Students

Teachers

Research

Sitemap

ch

Report of State Engineer 1

[← Go Back](#)

The lands bordering the Feather, Yuba and Bear Rivers, as well as those adjacent to....the Sacramento Valley, which have received the flow of debris or detritus, were for the most part naturally fertile, as all most alluvial bottoms ~~are~~...The lands were sometimes in a high state of cultivation, and were dotted with prosperous homes, fruitful orchards, and luxuriant fields. But a great change has been wrought in the landscape – one which is not pleasant to contemplate. By the rapid accumulation of the sands the natural channels of the Yuba and Bear Rivers were first obliterated, and the beds of the streams raised to a level with the top of their former banks. Levees that were thrown up to confine the waters to their accustomed courses only had the effect of causing the beds to rise still higher by the constant deposition of detritus between them, until they were overtopped by the floods, and the bottom lands were submerged from rim to rim of the adjacent plains with sand and clay sediment, to such depths that at places orchards, gardens, fields, and dwellings were buried from sight, landmarks were lost, and the course of the devastating flood was marked out by broad commons of slimes and sands....The adjacent lands are thus more easily overflowed, and although not buried with detritus, are rendered marshy, cold, and unsuceptible of cultivation. To say that they are "drowned out" expresses their condition precisely. (William H. Hall, Report of State Engineer, 1881)

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Effects on Fish

[<-- Go Back](#)

The Salmon certainly passed up these streams [Feather, Yuba and the American] for a few years after extensive mining was presented, but their spawning beds being covered by sediment, their eggs would not mature; and as the old fish died or were killed (no new ones taking their place), they became extinct in these streams. (Report of the Commissioners of the Fisheries, 1875)

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Nevada City Newspaper Opinion

[<-- Go Back](#)

The idea of the city of Marysville bringing suits to abate the hydraulic mining companies on the Yuba and its branches as a nuisance is preposterous; to do so would simply be the confiscation of millions of dollars of property. (Nevada City Transcript, November, 1879)

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[Home](#)

[Students](#)

[Teachers](#)

[Research](#)

[Site Map](#)

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Court Decision 1

[← Go Back](#)

The [defendant companies – North Bloomfield et al]....are perpetually enjoined and restrained from discharging or dumping into the Yuba river....any of the tallings, bowlders [sic], cobble stones, gravel, sand, debris or refuse matter.

Supreme Court Judge Lorenzo Sawyer, January 7, 1884)

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Court Decision 2

[<-- Go Back](#)

No person, natural or artificial, has the right, directly or indirectly, to cover his neighbor's land with mining.

(State Supreme Court decision upholding earlier Gold Run case, November, 1884)

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[Home](#)[Students](#)[Teachers](#)[Research](#)[Sitemap](#)**Keyword Search**

1893 Statute

[<-- Go Back](#)

The Civil Code of the State of California is hereby amended by adding thereto a new title, to be known as title nine....The business of hydraulic mining may be carried on within the State of California wherever and whenever the same can be carried on without material injury to the navigable streams, or lands adjacent thereto.

(Chapter 223, Statutes of 1893)

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Although there had been limited contact between the Indigenous nations and other cultures (such as Russian traders) in northern California prior to the Gold Rush, it wasn't until gold was discovered in May of 1849 on the banks of the Trinity River that miners from all over the world began to flock to the North Coast. Tens of thousands of men from all over the United States, as well as from countries such as China, Russia, Mexico, Chile, Peru, Australia and Great Britain came to the land, hoping to strike it rich by finding gold. These men came from all backgrounds; some were already rich and hoping to become fabulously wealthy, some owned nothing but the clothes on their backs, and some would go to any lengths to find their riches.

They brought with them their tools of the trade- the pick-ax, shovel, mining pan, and the gun. The first miners to arrive in the region used pans to find the easy gold. As more miners arrived, they began to use more elaborate devices to find the elusive metal. Rockers, or cradles, were used; miners could sift more dirt with them. Long toms and sluice boxes were the next inventions; these devices could move water and land in huge proportions each day. Mercury was used to find gold within sluice boxes. With these devices, miners found an estimated 3,950,000 troy ounces of gold in all of California by 1852. At today's standards that amount of gold would be worth about \$1.5 billion. (1)

Perhaps the most significant device used in the Gold Rush era was the water cannon. Invented in 1852 and used until the 1880s, hydraulic mining was used to break apart entire mountains and created massive environmental changes in northern California. This technology allowed miners to break up huge amounts of earth in a matter of hours that would previously taken weeks working with shovels and picks. The profit from hydraulic mining was high. A mining engineer's estimate in 1867 was made; if wages were \$4 a day, the cost of washing one cubic yard of gold-bearing rock with a pan would be \$20; with a rocker, \$5; with a long tom, \$1; and with a hydraulic operation, \$.20. (2) Miners soon further developed their technology with the invention of the steam-powered Blatchley diamond rock drill and the "Little Giant" hydraulic monitor in 1870, a device which was similar to a piece of artillery that could force out water at a pressure equal to a 500 foot column of water. These machines were mostly financed by wealthy San Francisco investors and water companies. (3)

Mining had transformed very quickly from the independent, solitary miner to companies of men who worked for powerful interests within California. The railroad and water industries would sell stock in mines to wealthy investors and hire miners at low wages to do the hard work of finding gold.

(1). "Discovery of Gold," Miners Collaborative. Big Bar, Ca. 1998.

(2). "Gold Mining in Siskiyou County 1850-1900," Gary D. Stumpf Siskiyou County Historical Society. 1998.

(3). "Gold, Greed and Genocide," Pratap Chatterjee. Inkworks Press, 1998.

[Return To Homepage](#)

[Click To Continue](#)

Bounty Hunting or Ethnic Cleansing? The act of paying for the death of another human being was practiced extensively by the California Legislature and the Federal Government during and after the Gold Rush. Towns and ranches throughout California also put out their own death warrants on indigenous people from 1848 to the 1870s.

Bounty hunting in northern California was often carried out by militias composed of local merchants and ranchers. Citizens in towns such as Crescent City and Eureka would form companies, electing their own officers. These militias varied from 35 to 97 men. (1)

Members of the three northern counties in the California Legislature urged Governor Leland Stanford and General Wright to call out local volunteers to end Indian problems once and for all in early 1863. Both officials agreed to this, and a proclamation was issued on February 7, 1863, calling for six companies of troops to be raised for action against the Indians in the Humboldt District. Commissions were issued to G.W. Ousley of Arcata and Charles W. Long of Eureka to enroll volunteers.

On July 13 enough troops had been raised to take over the garrisons, and Colonel S. G. Whipple relieved Colonel Lippitt as commander of the District. The organization was known as the First Battalion of Mountaineers, California Volunteers. The volunteers were to receive the same pay as regular troops, which was \$18 per month, plus \$100 bounty and clothes and food. A special tax of 15 cents per \$100 was also levied by the Humboldt County Board of Supervisors to provide extra pay and incentive to the Mountaineers. The California Legislature granted an additional \$5,391 on April 10 to defray expenses of recruiting and traveling. These men could only be used in clearing the hostile Indians from the Humboldt Military District. As soon as that job was accomplished they were to be discharged and not ordered East or anywhere else in the State.

Four companies with 80 men apiece were created. They set up garrisons and reinforced forts in places such as Iaqua, between Kneeland's Prairie and Yager Creek; Fort Gaston in Hoopa Valley; the Trinity border; the northern boundary of Mendocino County; Hydesville; Camp Gilmore at Trinidad and Camp Grant on the Eel River. (2)

These companies did not conduct a military campaign against an armed adversary. They murdered thousands of men, women, and children to clear the way for miners and ranchers to set up camp and create new towns.

An editorial from a newspaper of the time gives a different take on the "Indian Wars" in California.

"We have frequently had occasion to remark that the accounts of Indian hostilities, not only in the North, but in the South, are almost invariably exaggerated. A small affair is soon magnified into a battle, and the origin is not infrequently attributed to Indian Outrages, when the account should read 'White man's oppression.'

The Indian war is defunct. The whole matter has been a cowardly farce, the threatening legions of Indians turning out to be but about 100, seeking refuge in a brush from the rowdies who, on the least occasion, delight in the sport of shooting them. As in all cases of this kind, the fault has been with the whites."

Boarding Schools or Concentration Camps? The end of the Gold Rush era signaled a change in U.S. policy towards Native people. Instead of directly killing California indigenous people, reservations were created and indigenous people were re-located to them. The children were taken, often by force, away from their parents and to far-away re-education centers. Children as young as four attended these re-education centers. They were forced to cut their hair and give up their clothing upon arrival.

The girls wore dresses and the boys wore military-style uniforms. They were often segregated. The people who ran the centers were Anglo "teachers," or priests and nuns determined to "save" the Indians' souls by purging their native heritage. The children were forced to learn and speak only English. Girls were forced to learn how to sew, clean house and cook. Boys were forced to learn tanning, brick-making, and other manual chores. Speaking in your native language resulted in severe punishment, such as whippings, isolation, and the withholding of food. Children could not have visitors, including their parents, while they stayed at the centers. Some children stayed for years at a time. Indian children were often farmed out as free labor to white settlers in boarding school communities, and sometimes sold outright at auctions held by boarding school teachers. Kids sometimes risked their lives and escaped from these centers, traveling hundreds of miles to try and get back to their families and home. Some made it, some didn't.

The purpose for these re-education centers was to destroy Indian children and Indian cultures and create American children. By 1890, it was becoming too expensive for the United States Army to hunt down and kill indigenous people—it was easier and less costly to lie to Native people to get them to stop fighting for survival, then steal their children and take them thousands of miles away to re-educate them by force. This alternative to physical termination of a people has been copied by many regimes throughout history, among them Nazi Germany.

In northern California, children were often taken to boarding schools located in Riverside, Ca., and to various places in Oregon. A re-education center in Hoopa Valley near Fort Gaston also housed many local indigenous children as recently as 1932. An unidentified Yurok elder gave an account of boarding school life in Sweet Tears and Bitter Pills.

"You know how I was raised? In a boarding school, being slapped across the face, beaten for being an Indian, feeling ashamed of the color of my skin." (1)

Within indigenous communities, great-grandparents, grandparents, great-uncles and great-aunts are the people who lived through the boarding school cultural holocaust.

(1) "Sweet Tears and Bitter Pills," Mariana Kawall Leal Ferreira.